EXPERIMENT 12

Implementing Security Features and Governance Practices in Zoho Creator

Aim

Protect claim processing through controlled actions, validation, traceable changes and a reviewable administration process.

Record status

Existing application guards and audit evidence documented. Native Audit Trail review, backup restoration and separate-user security tests are pending.

Concept

Application security combines access control with validation and operating procedures. A custom Lifecycle_Audit field helps explain transitions, but it is editable application data unless separately protected. It should not be equated with an independent or immutable platform audit log.

Procedure

1. Classify claim fields and restrict report exports, edit rights and API access according to the intended user duties. Use fictional data for demonstrations.

2. Keep financial validation in server-side workflow logic. Recheck authorization within functions that perform protected actions.

3. Require fresh comments for transitions and retain actor, time and action details. Review access to the audit field itself.

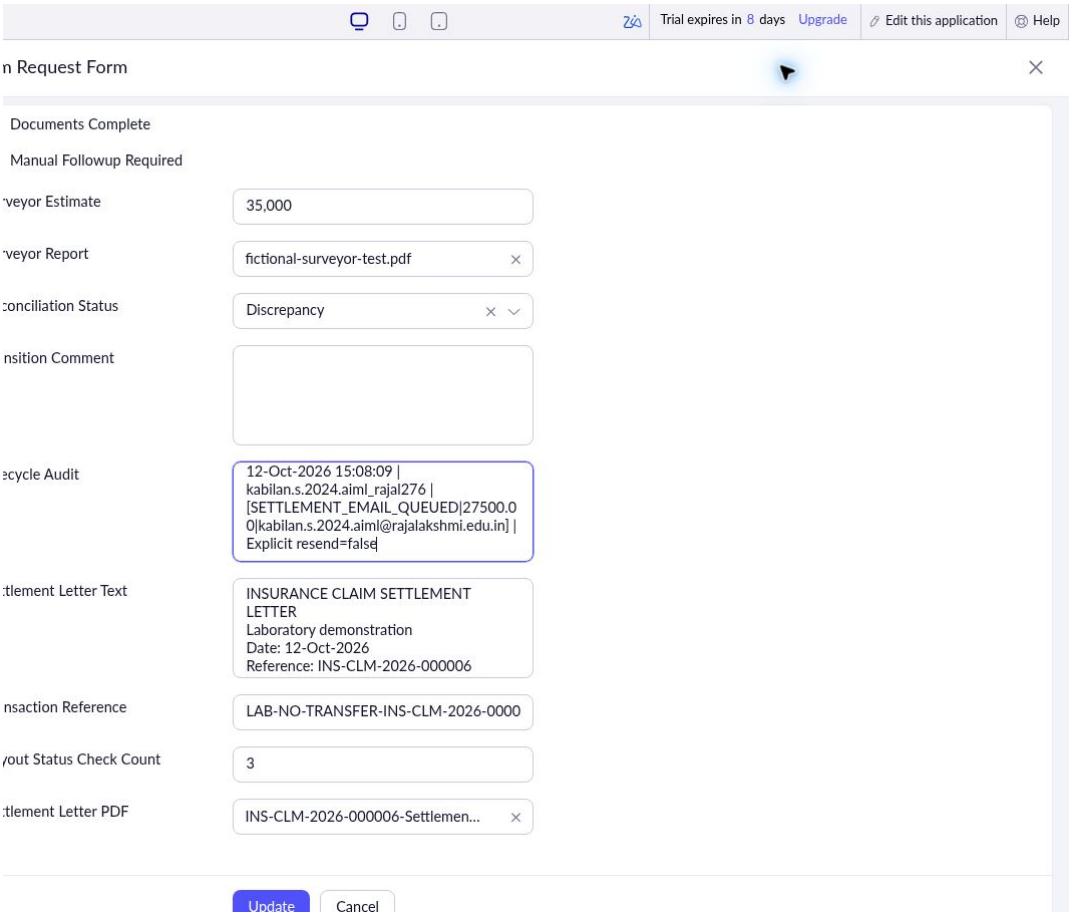
4. Inspect native Audit Trail for an approved test change and compare it with the custom lifecycle entry. Document any plan or retention limits shown by the account.

5. Review connection scopes, deployment access and notification recipients. Separate development fixtures from live data.

6. Create a supported backup and test recovery on an isolated copy. Record the restored version and verify the important records before treating recovery as proven.

Application design and observations

Control	Existing evidence or remaining work
Fresh transition comment	Saved, consumed and cleared after tested transitions
Financial validation	Invalid depreciation and direct settlement edits guarded
Protected functions	Owner checks and invalid-record handling tested in selected functions
Custom lifecycle audit	Tested application-level log of actions and messages
Native Audit Trail	Review pending; independent trail not verified
Recovery and access review	Backup restore and separate-account tests pending



Existing custom lifecycle audit and settlement-letter evidence for a fictional claim. It is separate from Creator native Audit Trail.

The test record contains fictional claim values. No encryption setting, MFA policy, data-retention rule or legal-compliance certification was changed or verified while preparing this record. Those controls require their own account-level evidence.

Validation and discussion

Test	Observed or pending
Fresh-comment reuse	Comment cleared after tested transitions
Invalid financial input	Depreciation above allowed range rejected
Direct Settled edit	Blocked by existing validation
Independent role boundary	Pending separate-account exercise
Native audit and restore	Pending native trail inspection and recovery test

Result

Application-level validation, selected function checks and lifecycle logging are documented with existing runtime evidence. Full governance acceptance still requires native Audit Trail inspection, independent access testing and a demonstrated restore procedure.

Viva focus

Explain the difference between a custom audit field, native Audit Trail and a tested recovery process.

Reading: Understanding audit trail (official Zoho documentation, reviewed 19 October 2026).

Reading: Privacy and security FAQ (official Zoho documentation, reviewed 19 October 2026).